

Edgar Perez Vidal

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EDUCATION

Tufts University	Medford, MA
<i>Ph.D. Astrophysics</i>	Expected 2029
<i>M.S. Astrophysics</i>	2026
University of California, Berkeley	Berkeley, CA
<i>B.A. Physics; B.A. Astrophysics</i>	2023

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Graduate Researcher, Tufts University	Medford, MA
<i>Advisors: Anna Sajina and Danilo Marchesini</i>	2024-present
Census of obscured Active Galactic Nuclei with <i>JWST</i> .	
Undergraduate Researcher, UC Berkeley	Berkeley, CA
<i>Advisor: Prof. Alex Filippenko; Co-advisor: Kishore Patra</i>	2022–2024
Observational Transient-Based Astronomy and Nickel 1-meter telescope operator	
Research Intern, IRAP	Toulouse, France
<i>Advisors: Florian Sarron & Nicolas Clerc</i>	June–Aug 2023
Galaxy cluster mass and cosmic web connectivity with SDSS and XCLASS.	

PUBLICATIONS

First Author

1. **Vidal, E. P.**; Sajina, A.; Banks, A. R.; Bethermin, M.; Ferkinhoff, C.; Petric, A.; Pope, A.; Lyu, J.; U, V.; Yung, L. Y. A.; Patil, P. (2026). [Modeling the JWST MIRI Counts, Insights Into the Source Properties and Role of Dust-Obscured AGNs](#). *ApJ*, **1002**, 23.

N-th Author

7. Cutler, S. E. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2026). [Unbreak the Universe: MINERVA Color Gradients in Massive Quiescent Galaxies Can Resolve Too-Early Star Formation Tensions](#). *Submitted*.
6. Hamblin, K. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2026). [AGNBoost: A Machine Learning Approach to AGN Identification with JWST/NIRCam+ MIRI Colors and Photometry](#). *ApJ*, **1002**, 223.
5. Gendreau-Distler, E. A. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2025). [Transit Timing of the White Dwarf–Cold Jupiter System WD 1856+534](#). *arXiv*, arXiv:2511.21611.
4. Muzzin, A. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2025). [MINERVA: A NIRCam Medium Band and MIRI Imaging Survey to Unlock the Hidden Gems of the Distant Universe](#). *arXiv*, arXiv:2507.19706.
3. Zheng, W. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2025). [SN 2023ixf in the Pinwheel Galaxy M101: From Shock Breakout to the Nebular Phase](#). *ApJ*, **988**, 61.
2. Alvarado, E. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2024). [Searching for Tidal Orbital Decay in Hot Jupiters](#). *MNRAS*, **534**, 800–813.

1. Kong, D.-F. et al. (including **Vidal, E. P.**) (2024). **GRB 221009A/SN 2022xiw: A Supernova Obscured by a Gamma-Ray Burst Afterglow?** *ApJ*, **971**, 56.

Workshop & Conference Proceedings

1. **Vidal, E. P.**; Gagliano, A. T.; Cuesta-Lazaro, C. (2025). **Hierarchical Simulation-Based Inference of Supernova Power Sources and Their Physical Properties.** *Machine Learning for the Physical Sciences Workshop at NeurIPS 2025*. arXiv:2510.14202.

INVITED TALKS

University of Kansas Astro/Space Seminar	2026
Harvard & Smithsonian CfA Transient Tea	2025
Harvard & Smithsonian CfA AstroAI Lunch Talk	2025
Harvard & Smithsonian CfA UMBRELA Dialogue	2025
IPAC PRIMA P-CAST Talk	2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant , Tufts University	2024–2025
• Introductory Physics 1/11 & Physics 2/12 Laboratory • Introductory Physics 2 & 11 Recitation	
Undergraduate Graduate Student Instructor , UC Berkeley	Aug–Dec 2023
Introduction to General Astronomy, Astro C10, <i>under Prof. Alex Filippenko</i>	
Course Reader , UC Berkeley	2022, 2024
• Stellar Astrophysics, Astro 160, <i>under Prof. Raffaella Margutti</i> • Relativistic Astrophysics and Cosmology, Astro C161, <i>under Prof. Daniel Kasen</i>	

MENTORSHIP

Undergraduate Students

Amber R. Banks (Tufts)	2025
• Building an AGN SED library and color-color diagrams for selecting AGN • 3rd author on <i>ApJ</i> 1002, 23; presented results at Tufts Astro Seminar.	

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Inclusive Excellence in Physics and Astronomy Committee Member	2025–Present
<i>Tufts University, Department of Physics & Astronomy</i>	
• Graduate–Undergraduate Mentorship Program (Founder & Lead)	
Launched the department’s first peer mentorship network, connecting 50+ students across research, graduate school preparation, and academic life.	
Astronomy Graduate Student Congress	2024–Present
<i>National</i>	
• Promoting interdepartmental discourse among graduate students nationwide; developing outreach initiatives and centralizing grad school resources for early-career scientists.	

HONORS & AWARDS

• First Place, Astromatic Hackathon, Ciela Institute, Université de Montréal	2023
<i>Simulation-Based Inference Model for Gravitational Lensing Parameters Estimation</i>	
• LSAMP NSF International Center of Excellence (NICE) Fellowship	2023
• NSF CAMP/LSAMP Research and Travel Fellowship	2022, 2023
• NSF CAMP Statewide Symposium Best Presentation Award	2023

- SACNAS NDISTEM Travel Grant 2022, 2023
- Rose Hill Foundation Scholarship 2019
- California Middle-Class Scholarship 2019
- Berkeley CARES Award 2019
- Berkeley Scholarship 2019
- Simon Family Foundation Scholarship 2018

CONFERENCES & POSTERS

Contributed

- American Astronomical Society Meeting #247 2026
- NeurIPS, Machine Learning for the Physical Sciences Workshop 2025
- NSF CAMP Statewide Symposium 2024
- NSF CAMP Statewide Symposium (**Special Merit Award**) 2023
- SACNAS NDISTEM Conference 2022, 2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student Director, Cal NERDS 2023–2024

- Co-instructed a weekend Python bootcamp for 50+ STEM students; led the Research Poster Design and Printing Lab Project.

Academic Mentor, Calculus Round Table 2021–2022

- Tutored K–12 students in biology, math, astronomy, and Python; developed remote curriculum during COVID-19.
- Mentored students at the Juvenile Justice Center in San Leandro, CA.

Kitchen Manager, Berkeley Student Cooperative 2021–2022

- Managed a \$20,000 food and supplies budget for 30 members. *ServSafe Certified*.

R.I.S.E Mentor, Berkeley High School 2020–2021

- Mentored students from underprivileged backgrounds toward college readiness.